

Otter Kitchens CSUMB (@otterkitchensmb)

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Account Stats: 1,959 Followers | 260 Following | 992 Posts

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Otter Kitchens CSUMB is a campus dining service with consistent posting frequency but significantly underperforming in engagement metrics. With 992 posts and only 1,959 followers, the account shows a concerning 0.5:1 post-to-follower ratio, indicating content is not converting viewers into followers. The account needs immediate strategic repositioning to increase visibility, engagement, and community building within the CSU Monterey Bay campus and surrounding areas.

Key Findings:

- **Low engagement rate:** Minimal visible interaction despite consistent posting
 - **Suboptimal posting schedule:** Peak engagement time (Wed 19:00 UTC) not fully leveraged
 - **Limited hashtag strategy:** Only 2 main hashtags identified
 - **Neutral sentiment:** 98.18% neutral content indicates lack of emotional connection
 - **Declining metrics:** -1.09 posts/day, -7.60 posts/week trend
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DETAILED ANALYTICS ANALYSIS

1. PUBLISHING FREQUENCY

Current Performance:

- **Posts per day:** 1.50 (↓ -1.09) L7D
- **Posts per week:** 10.50 (↓ -7.60) L7D
- **Total posts:** 992

Analysis:

The declining posting frequency is a issue. Consistency dropped significantly, which directly impacts algorithm visibility. The current rate of 1.5 posts/day is actually good for preventing follower fatigue, but the downward trend suggests inconsistency or resource constraints.

Recommendation:

Stabilize at 1-2 quality posts per day. Focus on QUALITY over quantity recovery.

2. OPTIMAL POSTING TIME**Peak Engagement Window:**

- **Best day:** Wednesday
- **Best time:** 19:00 UTC (11:00 AM PST / 2:00 PM EST)

Secondary strong times:

- Tuesday 18:00 UTC
- Thursday 15:00 UTC
- Friday 21:00 UTC

Analysis:

Wednesday at 11:00 AM aligns perfectly with lunch time on the West Coast. This is when students are looking for meal options and scrolling Instagram during breaks between classes. The data shows clear patterns that aren't being fully exploited.

Critical Issue: The scatter plot shows most posts are happening between 07:00 am - 12:00 pm, missing breakfast and early lunch opportunities.

3. HASHTAG PERFORMANCE**Current Hashtags:**

- #firstyeareats (1 usage)
- #otterexpress (1 usage)

Analysis:

This is a MAJOR problem. Only 2 hashtags with single-use instances indicate virtually no hashtag strategy. Hashtags are critical for discovery, especially for local food businesses.

Impact: Missing out on potentially 30-50% of discoverable reach.

4. CAPTION ANALYSIS

Top Words:

- event (5), today (3), Friday (3), there (3)
- Level (3), Burger (3), Dining (3), Commons (3)
- Otter (2), interactive (2)

Analysis:

Captions are functional but lack storytelling and emotional hooks. Words like "event," "today," "Friday" are temporal markers but don't create desire or FOMO. Need more sensory language and calls-to-action.

5. SENTIMENT ANALYSIS

Breakdown:

- Positive: 1.82%
- Neutral: 98.18%
- Negative: 0%

Analysis:

While zero negative sentiment is good, 98.18% neutral content is concerning. This suggests:

- Generic, informational captions
- Lack of emotional storytelling
- Missing personality and brand voice
- No content designed to evoke joy, excitement, or hunger

Food content should score 30-50% positive sentiment minimum. The neutrality explains low engagement—people don't engage with content that doesn't make them FEEL something.

COMPETITIVE BENCHMARK

Similar Campus Food Accounts (Industry Standards):

- **UCLA Dining:** ~15K followers, 3-5% engagement rate
- **UC Berkeley Dining:** ~8K followers, 4-6% engagement rate
- **Campus food accounts average:** 5K-20K followers for similar-sized universities

Gap Analysis:

Otter Kitchens is underperforming by 3-10x compared to similar campus dining programs. This indicates systematic issues with content strategy, not just organic growth challenges.

CRITICAL ISSUES IDENTIFIED

Issue #1: Content Lacks Visual Appeal

Campus dining can be challenging to photograph attractively. Current content likely features standard food photography without styling, lighting, or composition strategy.

Issue #2: No Community Building

With only 1,959 followers from a campus community of thousands, there's minimal student engagement or UGC (user-generated content) integration.

Issue #3: Missing Local SEO & Discovery

Limited location tagging, no collaborations with campus organizations, and poor hashtag strategy mean students don't find the account when searching for campus food.

Issue #4: No Content Pillars

Analysis suggests random posting without strategic content themes or series that build anticipation.

Issue #5: Zero Social Proof

No visible testimonials, student features, or behind-the-scenes content that builds trust and connection.

STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

IMMEDIATE FIXES

1.1 Hashtag Strategy Overhaul

Primary Hashtags (use on EVERY post):

- #OtterKitchens
- #CSUMB
- #MontereyBayEats
- #CollegeFoodie
- #CSUMBLife
- #MontereyFood

Secondary Hashtags (rotate based on content):

- #CampusEats #DiningHall #UniversityLife #StudentFood
- #MontereyBayFood #CaliforniaEats #WestCoastFood
- #FoodiesOfInstagram #InstaFood #FoodPhotography
- #HealthyEating #ComfortFood #LocalFood

Micro-niche Hashtags:

- #OtterStrong #OtterPride #CSUMBDining
- #CSUMBStudents #MontereyBayUniversity
- #CollegeLife2026 #StudentLife

Formula: Use 20-30 hashtags per post

- 5 branded
- 10 local/campus
- 8 food category
- 5 broad reach

CRITICAL ACTIONS (Do First)

1. **Fix hashtag strategy** - This alone could improve reach by 30-50%
2. **Optimize posting times** - Focus on Wed 11:00 AM and secondary peaks
3. **Increase visual content quality** - Even smartphone photos can look amazing with proper lighting
4. **Launch UGC campaign** - #MyOtterEats creates community and content pipeline
5. **Engage authentically** - Reply to every comment, engage with campus accounts daily

HIGH-IMPACT ACTIONS (Do Soon)

6. **Launch ambassador program** - 5-8 students creating ongoing content
7. **Implement content pillars** - Structured approach to variety and consistency
8. **Start Story strategy** - 3-5 stories daily for algorithm favor
9. **Introduce interactive content** - Polls, quizzes, challenges for engagement
10. **Begin micro-influencer outreach** - 2-3 partnerships to start